

How the ELF Epistemic Stack works

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claim. Not a slide deck!

Co-writing (straight)

This note was co-written with Gursor; the coding agent I work with daily. I call it
Brandon Flores's "vocal" layer, where human and AI co-engineer every line
sixteen years of industrial design before that. If a line here is wrong, the error is

1. The problem (same bug as Jun 21 / Jul 19)

That's claiming can cite one brochure and still get counted as three independent s
citations. That's slipped a provenance genealogy layer: counting and repeat
this page could suggest authority from something that asks where the author's b
infrastructure (and evidence) support COVID origins, LHC safety, or egg nutrition.

2. What the system does, in four stages

Four stages. Separate modules. Run in order.

Stage 1. Resolve identity (genealogy)

Code: src/epistemic/index.js, genealogy.js, source_identity.js

Level: a case folder (evidence_blocks.json, source_registry.json). Map every block to three

level: 1. Counts. Example quote in the JSON:

Lineage: One of the original observations. One experiment. One dataset, one generative event

needed. Number always increase. Counting claims overstates how many excerpts you

have. Lineage is the conservative count. Overstating independence is the failure mode we

inflation factor printed on the report: excerpts documents lineages, with a citation

Stage 2. Propose

Code: src/epistemic/adiudicate.js (propose). It is

propositional assumption, and reasoning steps. Each step must cite a block and quote the passage

That output is a proposal. Not a verdict.

Stage 3. Verify (deterministic)

Code: verifyCitations() in adiudicate.js, measure.js

No model in this stage. For each reasoning step:

2: Text quotes must appear verbatim in the cited block.

one study. We didn't invent that problem. We shipped tooling for the half that stays manual
unchallenged conclusions. Stages 2-4 force shown work, mechanical citation checks, then a
self-check. Case self-points the tool at claims about me. Mechanical challenger catches
oversight in my own evidence pages. I missed. Every entry names a test. npm run
verify:register fails if a claimed guard is missing.

4. What it does / doesn't (honest)

Does: solve claim, document lineage and print the conservative count
Doesn't: persist guard, persist lineage, persist judgment
Does: persist human positions
Doesn't: persist human positions
Does: papers (Elicit)
Doesn't: settle the underlying scientific questions
Does: claim stays narrow: structure and checkable independence, not better prose and not
domain expertise.

5. What's in the repo now (verify, don't trust me)

As of this build: npm test 188 passing in the epistack repo (no network). Re-run before
review.

Cheers! Where? COVER NOTE TO ELF.md
 Base repo: web/index.html • REFS PERIODIC.md
 Generated from: doctolib • doctolib/epistack (26 runs)
 Mechanical checks C1 C8 • src/epistemic/mechanical_challenge.js
 GitHub: https://github.com/brandon255/doctrine-labs-fff-epistack.git
 npm run epistemic:covid
 No install beyond Node 20. No API key. Mechanical half runs cold. Local model optional for live propose challenge. Prefer not to clone open doc transcripts or on GitHub.

What? Claim, how is a teenager while doing it built the navigation layer in the early
 part learning the domain as public
 What? I do not claim, first to notice the problem (Greenberg, 2009; Greenberg handbook). Senior
 engineer, credentials. That every adjacent to is worse. That CoVID-19 Ceregs are solved.
 I'm not submitting as an ongoing project. In submitting as a builder who found an
 infrastructure gap while doing LPL homework, then kept building.
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